County Administration Workshop: March 17, 2026
1:30 p.m. – Board of Commissioners Conference Room
Attending: Commissioners Ron Smith; Colene Martin; Gary Richardson; and Kassie Austin, Recorder

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 1:30 p.m.

DUE TO TECHNOLOGY ISSUES, ONLY AUDIO WAS RECORDED. THERE IS NO VIDEO

1. **Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest**

Each Commissioner present reviewed the agenda. It was determined that there were not any conflicts on today's agenda.

2. **Department Business**
   a. **Legal Counsel**
      1. **Order No. 2026-009; In the Matter of Adoption of the Josephine County Administrative Policy H-02: Exclusion from County Owned Property and Telephonic Contact Prohibition**

Wally Hicks, County Counsel, explained the cause of the and the Oregon Statue requirements. ORS 166.090 defines the term telephonic. This policy would allow designated staff to deem individuals' behavior as harassment. *Commissioner Richardson made a motion to approve the Order No. 2026-009; In the Matter of Adoption of the Josephine County Administrative Policy H-02: Exclusion from County Owned Property and Telephonic Contact Prohibition with the corrections discussed. The motion was seconded by Commissioner Martin. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.*

      2. **Order No. 2026-010; In the Matter of Josephine County Administrative Policy H-03: News Media Meeting Attendance**

Wally Hicks, County Counsel, explained that it is good practice to have a policy in place. This policy will especially be helpful regarding the county holding executive sessions. Mr. Hicks explained the Josephine County code and the provisions that lay how the county holds meetings and rules. Mr. Hicks explained the definitions of journalism. Mr. Hicks provided his legal opinion to allow a public comment period on this policy to hear back from the public. The board directed legal to allow a one-week public comment period and bring this matter back at the next administration workshop.

      3. **Order No. 2026-011; In the Matter of Repeal Order No. 2025-075; In the Matter of Implementing a Clear Bag Policy at Meetings of the Board of County Commissioners**

Wally Hicks, County Counsel, presented a proposal to repeal Board Order No. 2025-075, noting that the prior order was not incorporated into the Administrative Policy Manual. He recommended retaining language addressing unattended bags as abandoned property subject to removal and inspection. The Board discussed enforcement consistency and public communication regarding the policy. *Commissioner Martin made a motion to approve Board Order 2026-011; In the Matter of Repeal with the amendments of adding the language of unattended bags. The motion was seconded by Commissioner Richardson. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.*

      4. **Offer to Purchase County Real Property located at 210 Tacoma**

Helene Lulich, Property Manager, Helene Lulich, Property Manager, presented two offers received for the County-owned property located at 210 Tacoma Street and provided a detailed history of the property, including its prior use, vacancy since 2016, and limited utilization by Civil Air Patrol under a month-to-month agreement. She explained that the property originated as part of a larger parcel associated with airport planning and has been marketed for sale for an extended period. Ms. Lulich recommended accepting the higher full-price cash offer, noting that the property is not currently utilized by County departments and would benefit from redevelopment consistent with its original purpose. The Board discussed verifying documentation related to FAA requirements and funding sources associated with the property prior to finalizing the sale. *Commissioner Richardson made a motion that the county accepts the full price offer on 210 Tacoma after the paperwork identifying that there is no issue with the FAA. The motion was seconded by Commissioner Martin. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.*

      5. **Potential Purchase and Sale Agreement – County Real Property known as Dimmick Campus**

Helene Lulich, Property Manager, presented proposed counteroffers for the sale of the Dimmick Campus property and provided historical context regarding prior listing efforts, environmental cleanup, outstanding loan balances, and long-term County use considerations. The Board engaged in extended discussion regarding the outstanding loan balances associated

with the property, the potential relocation of affected departments, the long-term financial impacts of leasing versus ownership, the availability of alternative County-owned facilities, and the potential benefits of redevelopment, including housing opportunities. Commissioners emphasized the importance of planning for departmental relocation, including evaluating space needs, associated costs, and available facilities, while also recognizing the opportunity presented by a qualified buyer and the length of time the property has been on the market. *Commissioner Martin made a motion to approve the counter offers. The motion was seconded by Commissioner Richardson. Upon roll call, Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.*

6. Memorandum of Understanding between Josephine County and HP Civil, Inc. for use of County Property at 1798 SE N Street

Helene Lulich, Property Manager, explained that HP Civil would be using a portion of the building on N Street. There is a county department that is interested in moving their department to the property. Ms. Lulich presented a draft lease, that is still being updated. This is informational only. The board directed staff to continue to work on the negotiations.

7. Oregon Board of Pharmacy – Case No. 2025-0686

Wally Hicks, County Counsel, provided background regarding a lapse in 2005 related to licensing requirements. Scott Hyde, Community Justice Director, discussed the need for the County to obtain appropriate pharmacy licensing, including a DEA license.

8. Public Comment on BLM Western Oregon Timber Plan (Deadline March 23)

Wally Hicks, County Counsel**,** introduced the topic of public comment related to the BLM Western Oregon Timber Plan, noting the upcoming deadline of March 23.

b. Airport

1. Authorization for Josephine County Airports Management.

Cherie Jadot, Airports Interim Manager, presented information regarding authorization for Josephine County Airports management, providing an overview of current operational needs and administrative authority related to airport functions. Discussion included the scope of airport management responsibilities, coordination with federal and state regulatory requirements, and the importance of maintaining continuity in airport operations. Ms. Jadot outlined the need for clear authorization to ensure ongoing management, compliance, and oversight of airport activities. The Board approved without objections.

2. Transfer of Airport Improvement Program Funds

Cherie Jadot, Airports Interim Manager, presented information regarding the transfer of Airport Improvement Program (AIP) funds, explaining that such transfers are part of standard airport funding and project management processes. Discussion included the purpose of the funds, federal requirements associated with their use, and the need to ensure proper allocation in alignment with airport improvement projects and long-term planning efforts. The Board discussed general considerations related to funding management and compliance with applicable guidelines. The Board approved without objections.

c. Human Resources

1. Interim Emergency Manager Position
2. Supplemental Budget Request for $160,000.00 - Update
3. Personnel Requisitions
    a. Emergency Management, Firewise Communities Coordinator, Update Job Description
    b. Emergency Management, Interim Emergency Management Director, Create New Job Description
    c. Juvenile Justice, Group Life Counselor II, Update Job Description
    d. Parks, Park Aide, Add Two (2) Temporary Positions
    e. Parks, Park Caretaker, Add Three (3) Temporary Positions
    f. Technology, Web and Public Information Coordinator, Update Job Description
4. Personnel Actions
    a. Public Health, Licensed Practical Nurse – Jail Clinic, New Hire

Michelle Shaw, Human Resources Director, presented updates related to staffing, including the Interim Emergency Manager position, supplemental budget considerations, updated job descriptions, and personnel actions across multiple departments.

3. BOARD BUSINESS

A. Josephine County Director Job Descriptions

This matter was tabled.

B. Administrative Policy Article F-07: Records Retention

This matter was tabled.

4. OTHER

Commissioner Richardson made a note that a Community Development team member has been promoted to Senior Planner.

5. ADDITIONAL SUBJECT MATTERS FROM COMMISSIONERS/ANNOUNCEMENTS:

None heard.

The meeting adjourned at 3:40 p.m.